

New Faculty Onboarding Guide

A 30–60–90 Day Framework for Instructors

1. Purpose & Scope

This document serves as the official onboarding guide for new instructors joining the teaching faculty at Newton School of Technology, Bengaluru campus. It is intended for use by the Onboarding Lead, the Faculty Lead (manager), and the incoming instructor.

Newton School operates in close partnership with affiliated universities. Our instructors are not just subject-matter experts — they are learning facilitators who shape the academic experience of students. Many new hires transition from industry roles, which requires a deliberate adjustment in communication, pacing, and pedagogical thinking.

This guide defines a structured 30–60–90 Day Onboarding Framework with three goals:

- Ensure every new instructor understands the organization, culture, and academic ecosystem.
- Build portal proficiency, content creation skills, and classroom confidence progressively.
- Give the Faculty Lead and Onboarding Lead a clear mechanism to track, assess, and approve readiness at each milestone.

2. Onboarding Structure at a Glance

The three-month onboarding is divided into phases of increasing responsibility. Each phase has defined focus areas, actionable activities, and a manager-approved milestone gate before the next phase begins.

Phase	Days 1–30: Orientation	Days 31–60: Contribution	Days 61–90: Independence
Primary Focus	Understand & Observe	Assist & Contribute	Own & Deliver
Teaching Role	Observer	Lab Facilitator / Supporter	Independent Lecturer
Portal Role	Learner	Creator (guided)	Creator (independent)
Content Role	Reviewer	Contributor	Author & Designer
Approval Gate	30-Day Sign-off	60-Day Sign-off	90-Day Final Review

PHASE 1 | Days 1–30: Orientation & Understanding

3.1 Philosophy & Intent

The first 30 days are about immersion — not instruction. New instructors should resist the urge to jump into teaching before they fully understand the students, the course, and the culture. The focus is observation, listening, and system mastery.

Industry professionals often find this phase counter-intuitive. The key mindset shift is: in a classroom, the communication model is fundamentally different from a workplace meeting. Tone, patience, and clarity matter more than efficiency.

3.2 Key Areas of Focus

A. Team & Culture Integration

The instructor should spend meaningful time with existing team members — not just introductory chats, but structured conversations about the organization's teaching philosophy, how universities operate as partners, how semesters and cohorts are structured, and what students expect from instructors.

- Attend team meetings and observe team norms.
- Have one-on-ones with at least two senior instructors in the first two weeks.
- Understand the buddy/mentor system and be assigned a mentor by Day 3.

B. Learning Portal Proficiency

The learning portal is the operational backbone of all academic activity. The instructor must understand it from two perspectives:

- **Student Side:** Browse the student portal as if you are a student; understand how contest and assessment interfaces appear; note friction points students commonly face.
- **Instructor / Backend Side:** Create and release questions and assignments; schedule and manage classes; track student submissions and activity; understand how to release or lock content by date and cohort.

C. Classroom Observation

New instructors must attend live lectures and lab sessions across all subjects — ideally 2 to 3 days per subject — before they attempt any independent session. The purpose is to internalize:

- How experienced instructors structure the flow of a 60–90 minute lecture.
- How to read the room — pace, pauses, checking for understanding.
- How doubts are handled without derailing the class.
- How labs differ from lectures in tone and facilitation style.
- How discipline and participation are maintained simultaneously.

D. Course Content Review

Before teaching anything, the instructor must review all existing course material:

- All lecture slide decks (PPTs) for the subject.
- Worksheets, coding questions, and assignment sets.
- Question banks and previous exam or contest papers.

This review should help the instructor answer: What is the course trying to achieve? How does the difficulty progress across weeks? Where do students historically struggle?

E. Historical Context via Slack Channels

Every course has a history. Instructors should read through previous Slack discussions in subject channels to understand:

- Past decisions about content sequencing and format.
- Common student difficulties that recur across batches.
- Course improvements that were made and why.

3.3 Phase 1 Onboarding Checklist

	Activity	Owner	Status
☐	Introduced to all team members	Onboarding Lead	Pending
☐	Buddy/mentor assigned by Day 3	Faculty Lead	Pending
☐	Understands teaching philosophy and expectations	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Understands partner university structure and semester model	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Explored student-side portal end-to-end	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Completed instructor/backend portal training	Faculty Lead	Pending
☐	Can create questions and upload assignments independently	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Can schedule classes and release content on portal	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Can track student submissions on portal	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Attended live lectures for all subjects (min. 2 days each)	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Observed lab sessions for at least 2 subjects	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Reviewed all lecture PPTs and worksheets	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Reviewed question banks and previous exams/contests	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Read historical Slack discussions in subject channels	New Instructor	Pending

3.4 30-Day Milestone Outcomes

Expected Outcome	How to Verify
Portal proficiency — end-to-end	Demo walkthrough with Faculty Lead
Clear understanding of course objectives	Verbal explanation or short written summary
Awareness of classroom management norms	Observation debrief with mentor
Ready for guided contribution	Faculty Lead sign-off

3.5 30-Day Approval

PHASE 2 | Days 31–60: Contribution & Assisted Teaching

4.1 Philosophy & Intent

The second month shifts the instructor from observer to active contributor. The instructor begins helping students, facilitating labs, and creating course material — always with mentor oversight. By the end of this phase, the instructor should be able to function independently in structured lab settings and contribute meaningfully to the course content repository.

4.2 Key Areas of Focus

A. Student Interaction & Doubt Resolution

Instructors should now be the first point of contact for student doubts during non-lecture hours. This includes:

- Assignment and worksheet doubts via portal or Slack.
- Code debugging in lab settings.
- Concept clarification for students who are struggling.

At this stage, instructors should begin identifying common misconceptions and patterns in student errors — this insight will directly improve their future teaching and content creation.

B. Independent Lab Facilitation

Lab sessions are a lower-stakes environment for instructors to build facilitation confidence. By Week 6, the instructor should be able to run a full lab session independently including:

- Explaining the problem statement clearly at the start.
- Circulating and helping multiple students simultaneously.
- Debugging student code without just giving answers.
- Managing time across a 90-minute lab.

C. Content Creation

Content creation deepens an instructor's understanding of the subject. Instructors should contribute across multiple content types:

- **Worksheets:** 1 to 2 original worksheets with solutions.
- **Coding Questions:** at least 3 coding problems with test cases.
- **MCQs:** a set of 10 multiple-choice questions with correct answer keys.
- **PPT Sections:** contribute at least one module or topic slide set.
- **Practice Problems:** supplementary problems for students who need extra challenge.

All created content must be reviewed by the mentor or Faculty Lead before being released to students.

D. Advanced Portal Usage

As course content grows more complex, so do the portal operations. By Day 60, instructors should be able to independently:

- Create different question types (coding, MCQ, subjective, fill-in-the-blank).
- Design and publish structured assignments with instructions and deadlines.
- Set up lab exercises with test cases and evaluation criteria.
- Create and configure quizzes or small in-class assessments.

4.3 Phase 2 Onboarding Checklist

	Activity	Owner	Status
☐	Regularly helping students with assignment and coding doubts	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Demonstrated ability to explain concepts clearly to students	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Identifying and documenting common student mistakes	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Conducted at least 2 lab sessions independently	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Able to help students debug code without giving direct answers	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Managed multiple student queries in a single lab session	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Contributed at least 1 original worksheet with solutions	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Contributed at least 3 coding questions with test cases	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Contributed a set of MCQs with answer keys	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Contributed at least one PPT section or topic module	New Instructor	Pending
☐	All created content reviewed and approved by mentor	Faculty Lead	Pending
☐	Can create all question types on the portal independently	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Can create and publish complete assignments on portal	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Can create quizzes and configure assessments on portal	New Instructor	Pending

4.4 60-Day Milestone Outcomes

Expected Outcome	How to Verify
Confidently resolves student doubts independently	Observed by mentor during doubt session
Runs lab sessions without guidance	Faculty Lead lab observation
Content contributions reviewed and approved	Content audit by Faculty Lead
Full portal proficiency for all task types	Live portal demonstration

PHASE 3 | Days 61–90: Independent Teaching & Academic Ownership

5.1 Philosophy & Intent

The third month is about ownership. The instructor transitions from assisted contribution to full professional independence. By Day 90, they should be able to teach an end-to-end lecture, create and administer assessments, and contribute ideas to course improvement — without needing managerial oversight on routine tasks.

5.2 Key Areas of Focus

A. Independent Lecture Delivery

This is the primary milestone of Phase 3. The instructor should be able to conduct a full, structured lecture independently across the following dimensions:

- **Class flow and pacing:** introducing concepts progressively, not all at once.
- **Student participation:** using questions, cold-calling, and think-pair-share techniques.
- **Handling unexpected questions:** staying honest about uncertainty while keeping the class moving.
- **Time management:** covering the planned content within the session window.

B. Student Awareness & Personalized Support

Knowing your students is fundamental to effective teaching. By Day 90, instructors should:

- Know all students by name and recognize them individually.
- Understand which cohort each student belongs to and any context that matters.
- Have identified high-performing students who can support peers.
- Have identified struggling students who need additional attention or escalation.

This awareness enables more targeted instruction and prevents students from slipping through unnoticed.

C. Assessment & Contest Creation

Instructors must be able to independently design complete assessments:

- Design questions that test the appropriate level of understanding using Bloom's Taxonomy.
- Balance question difficulty across easy, medium, and hard tiers.

- Write clear and unambiguous problem statements.
- Structure assessments logically — warm-up to challenging.
- Test all questions and verify outputs before releasing to students.

D. Teaching Methodologies

Framework	Application in Classroom
Bloom's Taxonomy	Design questions and learning objectives across all six cognitive levels — from recall to creation. Avoid over-indexing on lower-order questions.
Psychological Safety	Students should feel safe to ask questions, make mistakes, and express confusion without fear of embarrassment. Instructors must model patience and openness explicitly.
Active Observation	During lectures and labs, actively circulate and read student body language, facial expressions, and engagement levels rather than only monitoring those who raise hands.
Participation Techniques	Use techniques like cold calling (with warmth), pair-and-share, exit tickets, and live polls to engage all students, not just the vocal ones.
Handling Difficult Situations	Have a clear protocol for managing student conflict, disengagement, or distress — including escalation paths to the Faculty Lead.

E. Continuous Improvement Contribution

By Day 90, instructors should not only execute the existing course but actively look to improve it. This means:

- Flagging outdated or unclear content with specific improvement suggestions.
- Proposing new teaching approaches or formats based on student feedback.
- Contributing ideas to improve student engagement in assessments or labs.
- Documenting insights about student difficulties for future onboarding cohorts.

5.3 Phase 3 Onboarding Checklist

	Activity	Owner	Status
☐	Conducted at least 2 full lectures independently	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Maintained appropriate class flow and pacing throughout	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Managed student participation effectively	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Handled unexpected student questions with confidence	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Knows 50+ students by name and cohort	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Identified high-performing and struggling students	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Created a complete quiz or short assessment independently	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Created at least one full assignment end-to-end	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Created a contest or exam with balanced difficulty	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Tested all questions before release to students	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Demonstrated understanding of Bloom's Taxonomy	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Applied psychological safety principles in class	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Contributed at least 1 course improvement suggestion	New Instructor	Pending
☐	Completed mentor debrief and final feedback session	Faculty Lead	Pending

5.4 90-Day Milestone Outcomes

Expected Outcome	How to Verify
Independent lecture delivery	Faculty Lead lecture observation + debrief
Student awareness — knows names, cohorts, needs	Instructor-led student walkthrough
End-to-end assessment creation and management	Review of created assessment artefacts
Applied pedagogical frameworks in class	Classroom observation + self-assessment
Active course improvement contributor	Written suggestion submitted to Faculty Lead

6. Final Readiness Assessment

Following the completion of all three phases and their respective approvals, the Faculty Lead conducts a Final Readiness Assessment to determine the instructor's deployment status.

Readiness Level	Description	Next Steps
Fully Independent	Instructor can teach, create assessments, manage students, and contribute to course improvement without supervision.	Assign full lecture schedule
Needs Minor Support	Instructor is proficient in most areas but requires occasional guidance on assessment design or classroom management.	Assign lectures with mentor shadowing for 2–3 more weeks
Needs Further Development	Instructor has gaps in core areas — teaching fluency, portal use, or student interaction — that require structured remediation.	Design a targeted 30-day improvement plan with weekly check-ins

Final Readiness Rating:

☐ Fully Independent ☐ Needs Minor Support ☐ Needs Further Development

7. Roles & Responsibilities

Effective onboarding is a shared responsibility. The table below defines what each stakeholder is accountable for during the three-month process.

Stakeholder	Key Responsibilities
Onboarding Lead	Designs and maintains this document; coordinates the onboarding schedule; ensures buddy assignment; facilitates milestone reviews; collects feedback to improve the process.
Faculty Lead (Manager)	Approves milestone gates; provides regular feedback; conducts classroom observations; signs off on final readiness; escalates concerns early.
Buddy / Mentor	Supports daily onboarding questions; co-reviews content before submission; shadows the new instructor during early lab sessions; provides informal feedback.
New Instructor	Takes ownership of their own onboarding; completes all checklist items proactively; asks questions early; produces required content contributions; seeks feedback actively.

8. Quick Reference: Onboarding Contacts & Resources

Resource / Contact	Details / Link
Faculty Lead	Name & contact to be filled by Onboarding Lead
Buddy / Mentor	Name & contact to be filled on Day 1
Learning Portal URL	To be shared by Faculty Lead
Subject Slack Channels	To be added by Onboarding Lead
Course Content Repository	Shared drive link — to be filled
HR / Admin Contact	To be filled by Onboarding Lead
This Onboarding Guide	Version maintained by Onboarding Lead

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